T. M. Jensen Ahokovi

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Education

Stanford University July 2025 – present

Non-matriculated graduate student.

Selected coursework: Topics in Economic History (ECON 229, PhD); Proofs and Modern Mathematics (MATH 56); Functions of a Real Variable (MATH 115).

University of Hawai'i at Mānoa 2021–2024

BA in Economics, cum laude. Quantitative Economics Concentration.

Selected coursework: Calculus I (MATH 241); Calculus II (MATH 242); Calculus III (MATH 243); Introduction to Linear Algebra (MATH 311); Advanced Mathematics (MATH 321); Econometrics I (ECON 628, PhD); Introduction to Econometrics (ECON 425); Economic Forecasting (ECON 427); Machine Learning Methods (ICS 235).

Iolani School 2015–2021

High school diploma.

Research experience

Predoctoral Research Fellow July 2025 – present

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR)

TAX Lab, Stanford Graduate School of Business (GSB) Palo Alto, CA

Research Fellow under Professors Ran Abramitzky and Rebecca Lester (Stanford GSB).

- Built data pipelines in R, Python, and SQL to support statistical analyses of public and proprietary datasets comprising millions to billions of observations.
- Developed statistical models for exploratory data analysis and causal inference, examining the impact of economic shocks and various public policies.
- Translated complex analyses into accessible findings, creating data visualizations, reports, and presentations for both technical and general audiences.

Research Assistant, Economic Policy Studies July 2024 – May 2025

American Enterprise Institute for Public Policy Research (AEI) Washington, D.C.

Research Assistant to economists Stan Veuger, Paul Kupiec, and Vincent Smith.

- Built and analyzed economic datasets in Stata, R, and Python to support research on public spending, international food aid, and population change.
- Applied causal inference methods, including instrumental variables and difference-in-differences, to examine the effects of government policies on economic and political outcomes.
- Translated technical analyses into accessible findings, contributing tables, visualizations, and written summaries for research papers and policy materials.

Research Assistant Nov. 2023 – June 2024

University of Hawai'i Economic Research Organization (UHERO) Honolulu, HI

Assisted economists Dylan Moore, Peter Fuleky, and Rachel Inafuku.

- Analyzed social-network and income data to examine economic inequality in Hawai'i, contributing to a coauthored policy brief.
- Prepared economic data for quarterly forecasting and academic research, collecting, organizing, and checking inputs for analysis.
- Produced statistical summaries and visualizations to interpret economic patterns and communicate findings.

Research experience (continued)

Research Fellow Aug. – Nov. 2023
Center for Entrepreneurship and Economic Education Honolulu, HI
Research assistant to economist Gerard Dericks.

- Analyzed historical housing data in R and Excel for research on house prices and housing supply restrictions.
- Reviewed empirical methods and findings from prior studies to inform the project's measures and analytical approach.
- Helped develop the empirical strategy, connecting the research question to the available data and proposed statistical analysis.

Research Associate July 2021 – Dec. 2023
Grassroot Institute of Hawai'i Honolulu, HI

- Applied econometric methods in R to analyze Hawai'i public-policy questions, including housing affordability.
- Translated quantitative analysis into policy research, contributing work cited by the Wall Street Journal and Honolulu Star-Advertiser.
- Presented empirical findings to lawmakers and public audiences, explaining their implications for state and local policy.

Institute Scholar Summers 2021 and 2022
Urban Land Institute Honolulu, HI

- Developed workforce-housing proposals for Oahu with fellow participants and urban-development specialists.
- Gathered stakeholder input through community outreach and meetings to inform housing proposals.
- Prepared and presented project recommendations to local lawmakers and industry executives.

Other experience

Ambassador Jan. – June 2024
TBSE Economics Bridge Program Honolulu, HI

- Supported pathways into economics for underrepresented students, particularly Pacific Islanders, helping community-college students transition to undergraduate study at UH Mānoa.
- Explained academic pathways and program opportunities, helping students understand available coursework, peer support, and options for continuing their education.
- Provided peer guidance and encouragement, drawing on personal experience in economics to help students navigate an unfamiliar university environment.

Busser July 2021 – May 2022
Ruth's Chris Steak House, Waikiki Honolulu, HI

- Supported service at a high-volume fine-dining restaurant, coordinating with servers to keep tables ready and service moving during busy shifts.
- Handled competing demands under pressure, balancing table clearing, resets, and guest requests as service needs changed.
- Communicated calmly with guests and coworkers, responding to requests and helping the team maintain attentive service.

Technical skills and languages

Programming: R, Stata, Python, and SQL.

Statistical methods: Regression analysis, statistical modeling, and causal inference: instrumental variables (IV), difference-in-differences (DiD), synthetic control, and synthetic DiD.

Data visualization: ggplot2, Matplotlib, ArcGIS; statistical and geospatial visualization.

Computing: Git and cluster computing.

Data platforms: Redivis and Snowflake.

Software: LaTeX and Microsoft Office (Excel, Word, and PowerPoint).

Languages: English (fluent), French, and Tongan (conversational).

Research

Authored work

The Costs of Mandates that Waste US International Emergency Food Aid Resources: New Evidence
With Vincent H. Smith and Philip G. Hoxie. AEI Economics Working Paper 2025-08, Dec. 2025.
[Link to AEI working paper version]

Taxation-Induced Tenancy: Evidence from Washington D.C.
Sole author. Working paper, July 2024. Manuscript available upon request.

Wealth by Association? How Social Networks Drive Inequality in Hawaii
With Dylan Moore. UHERO Brief, Apr. 2024.
[Link to published brief]

The Supply Effects of Rent Control: New Evidence from New York
Sole author. Working paper, Oct. 2023. Manuscript coming soon.

Works in progress

Population Drops in Attractive Areas
With Ed Glaeser, Ferdinando Monte, and Stan Veuger.

How Effective is In-Kind Food Aid? Evidence from USAID
With Phil Hoxie and Vincent Smith.

What Can 'Longest-Run' House Price Indices Tell Us About the Current Housing Crisis?
With Gerard Dericks.

Research assistance

Research assistant on the following papers; authors listed below.

Intergovernmental Grants to School Districts and Educational Outcomes During the COVID-19 Pandemic
By Jeffrey Clemens, Philip G. Hoxie, and Stan Veuger. National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) Working Paper 35447, July 2026.
[Link to NBER working paper version]

Aid for Incumbents: The Electoral Consequences of COVID-19 Relief
By Jeffrey Clemens, Julia Payson, and Stan Veuger. Public Choice 206, 363–390 (2026); National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) Working Paper 32962, Sept. 2024.
[Link to published version] [Link to NBER working paper version]

Firms' Real and Reporting Responses to Taxation: A Review
By Rebecca Lester and Marcel Olbert. Journal of Accounting and Economics 80(2–3), Article 101837 (2025).
[Link to published version]

Conference presentations and invitations

Taxation-Induced Tenancy: A Case Study of Washington D.C.'s Vacancy Tax

National Tax Association Annual Conference on Taxation, Detroit, MI	Invited, Nov. 2024
North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association, Washington, DC	Presented, Sept. 2024
National Conference on Undergraduate Research, Council on Undergraduate Research, Long Beach, CA	Invited, Apr. 2024
Undergraduate Showcase, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, Honolulu, HI	Presented, Dec. 2023

What can 'longest-run' house price indices tell us about the current housing crisis?

People, Planet and Prosperity Conference, Chaminade University, Honolulu, HI	Aug. 2022

Honors and affiliations

Honors and awards: Member, Omicron Delta Epsilon Economics Honor Society; Member, Pi Gamma Mu International Honor Society in Social Sciences; Dean's List, College of the Social Sciences; HEA Scholarship recipient, Hawaii Economic Association; Pipeline Scholar, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association; Don Lavoie Fellow, Mercatus Center, spring 2025.

Professional affiliations: Student member, National Association for Business Economics; Student member, Hawaii Economic Association; Founding member and Director of Professional Development, Mānoa Economics Association.

References available upon request.